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APPS



Jack Dorsey's latest app tracks sun exposure

Twitter co-founder Jack Dorsey is on an app-building spree. After releasing [a Bluetooth-based messaging app called Bitchat](#) earlier this month, this weekend Dorsey revealed another app called Sun Day that ostensibly helps users track UV exposure and vitamin D intake.

The new app is [available via TestFlight on iOS](#), and its code is on GitHub for anyone to clone.



jack



@jack · Follow



track your (vitamin) D

a Sun Day app for Sunday.



testflight.apple.com

Join the Sun Day Tracker beta

Available on iOS

1:41 PM · Jul 13, 2025



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Like other developers, Dorsey is riding the vibe-coding bandwagon. But instead of using Cursor, Claude Code, or Windsurf, he [says](#) he is using an open source coding tool [called Goose](#).

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Sun Day is simple to use. It shows you the UV Index for your location along with details like cloud cover, sunrise, and sunset timings. You can choose your skin type from six options, and what kind of clothing you're wearing. Based on these parameters, the app will calculate how long you can expose your skin to sunlight before it starts to burn.

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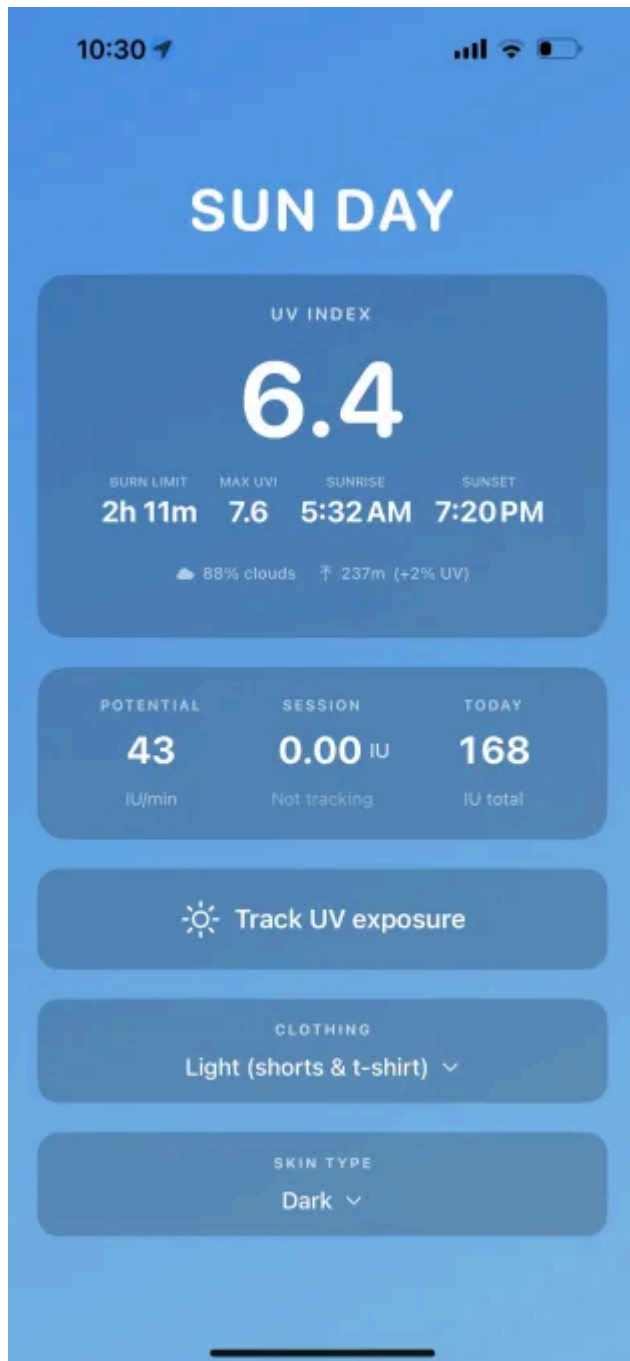


IMAGE CREDITS: TECHCRUNCH (SCREENSHOT)

The app also shows your minimum vitamin D intake. Start a session by tapping on the “Track UV exposure” button, and after the session is ended, the app will show how much vitamin D you’ve gained throughout the session, and in the day.

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Jack Dorsey’s Bluetooth messaging app Bitchat now on App Store

Amanda Silberling — 7:51 AM PDT · July 29, 2025

[Bitchat](#), a messaging app created by Twitter and Block founder Jack Dorsey, is available to download from the [iOS App Store](#). Dorsey says he coded the basis of the app over the course of a weekend in early July.

Bitchat operates through Bluetooth mesh networks, which means that users can send messages to others within the range of Bluetooth connectivity — usually around 100 meters — without cell reception or a Wi-Fi connection.

The app's UX is very minimal. There is no log-in system, and you're immediately brought to an instant messaging box, where you can see what nearby users are saying (if anyone is actually around you and using the app) and set your display name, which can be changed at any time.

While Bitchat is sparking interest due to Dorsey's reputation, the concept of Bluetooth-powered messaging apps is not new. These apps are also popular in settings like large music festivals, where cell service may be limited, or in the aftermath of natural disasters, where cell service and Wi-Fi availability may be impacted. The Bluetooth messaging app [Bridgefy](#) was notably used during pro-democracy [protests](#) in Hong Kong, since its ability to function without the internet made it harder for authorities to detect.

Dorsey advertised Bitchat as a secure, private messaging platform when it went live for beta use earlier this month. But security researcher Alex Radocea [pointed out in a blog post](#) that it's easy to impersonate other people within Bitchat, calling into question how secure the "[vibe-coded](#)" app really is.

"In cryptography, details matter," Radocea wrote. "A protocol that has the right vibes can have

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fundamental substance flaws that compromise everything it claims to protect.”

Dorsey later admitted that the software had [not been subject to an external security review](#) and thus may contain vulnerabilities.

Bitchat’s concerns around impersonation also extend to the app itself. As of now, the app can be downloaded for iOS via the App Store, or it can be loaded onto an Android device by [downloading the app from GitHub](#). However, the Google Play store hosts multiple apps that appear to be pretending to be Dorsey’s app, which have garnered thousands of downloads.

Dorsey has not directly addressed the fake Bitchat apps on the Google Play store, but he did repost [another user’s X post](#) that said that Bitchat is not yet on Google Play, and to “beware of fakes.”

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Amanda Silberling

Senior Writer |

Amanda Silberling is a senior writer at TechCrunch covering the intersection of technology and culture. She...

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Decentralized social networking app Damus to be removed from App Store, will appeal decision

Aisha Malik — 2:44 PM PDT · June 26, 2023

Damus, a [decentralized social networking app](#) backed by Twitter co-founder Jack Dorsey, will be removed from the App Store due to Apple's strict payment rules. Apple had threatened to remove Damus earlier this month over the app's tips feature, claiming that it could be used by content creators to sell digital content on the platform.

The tech giant has a long history of prohibiting developers from selling additional in-app content unless the transactions go through Apple, which takes a 30% cut. To avoid a ban, the team behind Damus had to tweak the app's tipping feature, which is made possible by way of Bitcoin's Lightning Network. The company previously explained in [a tweet](#) that it had to remove the tips button from posts and was only allowed to permit tips on profiles.

IMAGE CREDITS: DAMUS

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wrote that “although tips or donations may be optional, if they are connected to or associated with receiving digital content, they must use in-app purchase in accordance” with its guidelines.

A spokesperson for Apple told TechCrunch in an email that the company rejected the app upon receiving Damus’ latest submission, noting that the issues it had previously outlined were unresolved.



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Damus plans to file an appeal to fight Apple's decision.

"Looks like we are getting removed from the App Store even after updating our app to make it clear that no digital content is getting unlocked when users are tipped," Damus wrote in [a tweet](#). "Users are only ever tipped after posts are made, the idea that content is being sold is nonsense. We will be filing an appeal as this guideline is clearly being abused and misapplied."

Last year, Twitter co-founder Jack Dorsey donated around \$245,000 in bitcoin (then roughly 14 BTC) to fund the development of an open and decentralized social networking protocol known as Nostr, which is based on cryptographic key pairs. Damus is the first mobile app to leverage the protocol. Dorsey reacted to Apple's decision in a tweet on Monday, outlining [that "tips aren't unlocking content."](#)

Tips aren't unlocking content, [@Apple](#)
<https://t.co/4OFHMml7tm>

— jack (@jack) [June 26, 2023](#)

Damus hit the App Store in February and was one of many Twitter rivals to emerge following Elon Musk's takeover of the social network, which had driven Twitter users to try out decentralized social networking services, like Mastodon. Damus has seen approximately 255,000 downloads globally on iOS since its release, according to mobile analytics firm data.ai.

The app's promise is an open social network without a central authority that makes decisions about the network's content or who's allowed to participate, as Facebook or Twitter do. Damus has

end-to-end encrypted messaging and does not require users to sign up with a phone number, email, or name because of how the Nostr works.

It's worth noting that this isn't the first time that Damus has run into issues with Apple. Damus faced some issues when going through the app review process due to its decentralized nature, as Apple had kept asking the app to follow the same rules as any other social network, such as providing a way for users to flag objectionable content and having a policy that makes it clear that abuse is not allowed.

The company previously said the app had [been rejected repeatedly](#), despite making changes to adhere to the tech giant's guidelines. That changed in February, when the app was finally approved.

Damus, another decentralized social networking app, arrives to take on Twitter



Another decentralized social networking application to challenge Twitter has hit the App Store. Last year, Twitter co-founder Jack Dorsey donated around \$245,000 in bitcoin (then roughly 14 BTC) to fund the development of an open

and decentralized social networking protocol known as Nostr, which is based on cryptographic key pairs. Now, the first

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Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter | [X](#)

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Jack Dorsey pumps \$10M into a nonprofit focused on open source social media

Sarah Perez — 9:01 PM PDT · July 16, 2025

Twitter co-founder and Block CEO Jack Dorsey isn't just vibe coding new social apps, like [Bitchat](#) and [Sun Day](#); he has also invested \$10 million in an effort to fund experimental open source projects and other tools that could ultimately transform the social media landscape.

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These efforts are funneled through an online collective called “[andOtherStuff](#),” formed in May, whose team includes Dorsey; Twitter’s first employee, Evan Henshaw-Plath; “Calle,” creator of the e-cash platform [Cashu](#); Alex Gleason, former [engineering head](#) at Truth Social; and [Jeff Gardner](#), the fourth employee at Intercom.

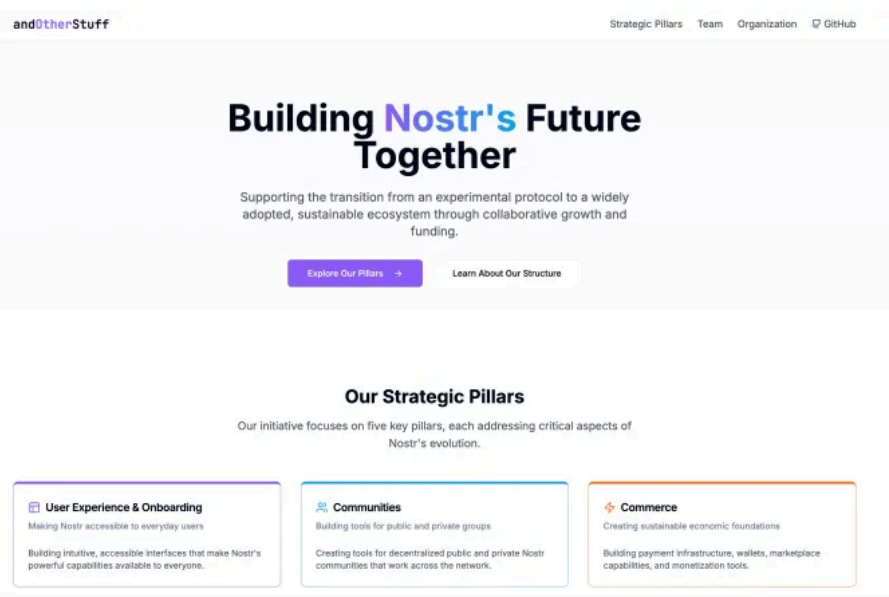


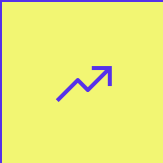
IMAGE CREDITS:AND OTHER STUFF

The group originally met through collaborating on [Nostr](#), an open, “apolitical” social networking protocol that has been receiving the bulk of Dorsey’s attention since [Twitter’s sale to Elon Musk](#) and his [stepping down from social network Bluesky’s board](#). However, the team will experiment with other tools, too, like ActivityPub, the protocol that powers the decentralized app Mastodon and others, as well as Cashu.

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IMAGE CREDITS: CASHU

In recent years, Dorsey has [been more critical](#) of how social media platforms have evolved, saying that [Twitter should have never been a company](#) and that Bluesky seemed to be [repeating the mistakes](#) he and others made at Twitter.

As a result, the team at “andOtherStuff” is determined not to build a company but is instead operating like a “community of hackers,” explains Henshaw-Plath. Together, they’re working to create technologies that could include new consumer social apps as well as [various experiments, like developer tools or libraries](#), that would allow others to build apps for themselves.

For instance, the team is behind an app called [Shakespeare](#), which is like the [app-building platform Lovable](#), but specifically for building Nostr-based social apps with AI assistance.

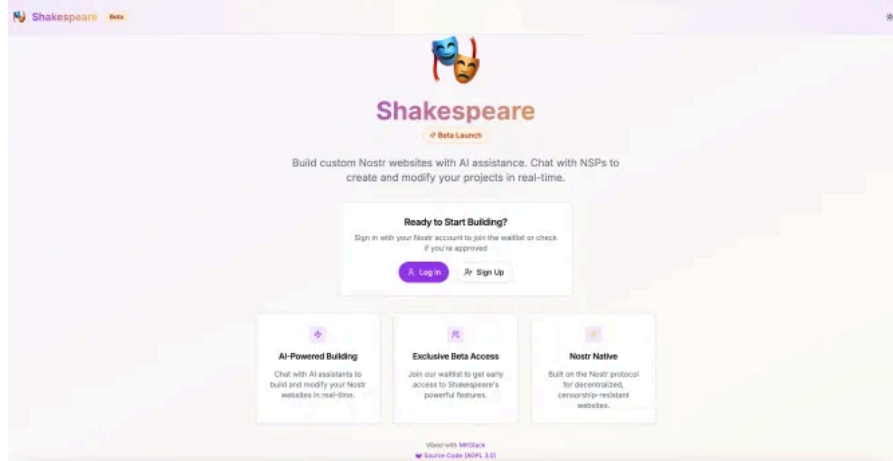


IMAGE CREDITS: SHAKESPEARE

The group is also behind [heynow](#), a voice note app built on Nostr; [Cashu wallet](#); private [messenger White Noise](#); and the Nostr-based [social community +chorus](#), in addition to the apps Dorsey has already released.

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Developments in AI-based coding have made this type of experimentation possible, Henshaw-Plath points out, in the same way that technologies like Ruby on Rails, Django, and JSON helped to fuel an earlier version of the web, dubbed [Web 2.0](#).

Related to these efforts, Henshaw-Plath sat down with Dorsey for the debut episode of his new podcast, [revolution.social with @rabble](#). (Henshaw-Plath’s handle on X is [@rabble](#).)



Since Dorsey lives in Costa Rica and Henshaw-Plath lives in New Zealand, the two met up at a hackathon in Switzerland for the chat. In the nearly hour-long episode, Dorsey delves into Twitter’s history as well as his philosophies around where social media went wrong and how it can be fixed.

“It took me a long time to realize this ... I didn’t really put it into words until I came back as CEO the second time. But it’s hard for something like [Twitter] to be a company, because you have corporate incentives when it wants to be a protocol,” Dorsey says. He notes that Twitter was at the mercy of its advertisers — something Musk also faces despite taking Twitter, now called X, private. Musk has even threatened advertisers with [lawsuits](#) over ad boycotts driven by their concerns over X’s lack of moderation and controversial comments Musk has made.

While Dorsey understands that catering to advertisers was correct for the business and for Twitter’s stock price, it was the “wrong thing for the internet.”

“They can just remove the money — your money — and your revenue goes down completely,” Dorsey

says of advertisers' power. "So if [Twitter] were an open protocol, if it were truly an open project, you could build a business on top of it, and you could build a very healthy business on top of it."

Dorsey eventually funded an effort to build an open protocol inside Twitter, which later spun out to become Bluesky. But Dorsey believes Bluesky faces the same challenges as traditional social media because of its structure — it's funded by VCs, like other startups. Already, it has had to [bow to government requests](#) and [faced moderation challenges](#), he points out.

"I think [Bluesky CEO] Jay [Graber] is great. I think the team is great," Dorsey told Henshaw-Plath, "but the structure is what I disagree with ... I want to push the energy in a different direction, which is more like Bitcoin, which is completely open and not owned by anyone from a protocol layer. That's what I see in Nostr as well," he says. "That's where I want to push my energy ... into the more corporate direction, even if it is a public benefit corporation," Dorsey adds.

IMAGE CREDITS: [ANDOTHERSTUFF](#)

In later episodes, Henshaw-Plath will interview others who have insight into how social media and tech have evolved, including journalists like Kara Swisher and Taylor Lorenz; former Twitter head of

Trust and Safety Yoel Roth; Substack co-founder Chris Best; Medium CEO Tony Stubblebine; [Cory Doctorow](#) (who coined the term “[enshittification](#)” to describe the state of much of the current web); and renowned misinformation researcher Renée DiResta.

The team at “andOtherStuff” is also working on a [social media “Bill of Rights,”](#) says Henshaw-Plath, which spells out what social media platforms [need to provide](#) in areas like privacy, security, interoperability, transparency, identity, self-governance, and portability.

This, they believe, will help platforms, including Bluesky and others, remain accountable to their users despite any outside pressure.

Dorsey’s initial investment has gotten the new nonprofit up and running, and he worked on some of its initial iOS apps. Meanwhile, others are contributing their time to build Android versions, developer tools, and different social media experiments.

More is still in the works, says Henshaw-Plath.

“There are things that we’re not ready to talk about yet that’ll be very exciting,” he teases.

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